

## SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

# Party Politics 1947-67: The Congress System & the Opposition - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

| Party Politics 1947-67: The Congress System & the Opposition                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                |
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| REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                |
| 01 FOUNDATION — CONGRESS'S DOMINANT POSITION AT INDEPENDENCE, 1947<br>Technically, FOUNDATION — Congress's dominant position at   | 02 FOUNDATION — THE 1948 BAN ON DUAL PARTY MEMBERSHIP<br>Forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an                         |
| 03 FOUNDATION — THE TANDON-NEHRU CONTEST, 1950-51<br>Core claim: This session traces Congress's own internal leadership           | 04 CORE — THE BHARATIYA JANA SANGH, 1951<br>Prelims: Do not confuse the Jana Sangh (1951, Mookerjee) with the                                  |
| 05 CORE — KMPP INTO THE PRAJA SOCIALIST PARTY, 1951-52<br>The merger created the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split  | 06 CORE — THE SWATANTRA PARTY, 1959<br>Its economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation                                       |
| 07 CORE — THE 1964 SPLIT IN THE COMMUNIST PARTY OF INDIA<br>Core claim: This session shows that party fragmentation was not       | 08 CORE — RAJNI KOTHARI'S 'CONGRESS SYSTEM'<br>Mains: Use Kothari's framework to answer any question asking for an                             |
| 09 CORE — SEAT MAJORITIES ON A MINORITY VOTE SHARE<br>Core claim: This session supplies the arithmetic evidence behind            | 10 CORE — SMALLER LEFT FORMATIONS AND THE PLURAL LEFT<br>The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc were                     |
| 11 CORE — CONGRESS AS AN UMBRELLA ORGANISATION<br>Prelims: Do not describe Congress in this period as ideologically               | 12 CORE — THE RISE OF STATE-LEVEL 'SYNDICATE' BOSSES<br>By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders had become                      |
| 13 CORE SYNTHESIS — RAM MANOHAR LOHIA AND 'NON-CONGRESSISM'<br>Prelims: Do not claim non-Congression achieved practical electoral | 14 CORE SYNTHESIS — THE IDEOLOGICAL RANGE OF THE NON-CONGRESS OPPOSITION<br>Prelims: Do not present the pre-1967 opposition as weak because it |
| 15 CORE SYNTHESIS — 1967: THE WATERSHED FORESHADOWED<br>Prelims: Do not present 1967 as a sudden, unexplained event; it is the    |                                                                                                                                                |

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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# Party Politics 1947-67: The Congress System & the Opposition - Solved Practice Workbook

## BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

### Q1. Which statement correctly identifies The 1948 ban on dual party membership?

A. Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. B. Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. C. J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s. D. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under The 1948 ban on dual party membership?

A. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. B. Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. C. J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s. D. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Q3. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The 1948 ban on dual party membership?

A. J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s. B. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. C. Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. D. Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q4. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The 1948 ban on dual party membership?**

A. Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade. B. The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. C. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. D. Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The Tandon-Nehru contest, 1950-51?**

A. Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. B. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model. C. J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s. D. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The Tandon-Nehru contest, 1950-51?**

A. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. B. Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. C. Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade. D. J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s.



**Answer: B. Explanation: Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q7. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The Tandon-Nehru contest, 1950-51?**

A. The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. B. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. C. Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. D. Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q8. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The Tandon-Nehru contest, 1950-51?**

A. In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. B. Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade. C. The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. D. Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q9. Which statement correctly identifies The Bharatiya Jana Sangh, 1951?**

A. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model. B. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. C. Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade. D. J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC**

elimination.

**Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under The Bharatiya Jana Sangh, 1951?**

A. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. B. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model. C. The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. D. Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q11. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The Bharatiya Jana Sangh, 1951?**

A. The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. B. In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. C. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model. D. Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q12. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The Bharatiya Jana Sangh, 1951?**

A. The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. B. In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. C. The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress. D. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC**



elimination.

**Q13. Which statement correctly identifies KMPP into the Praja Socialist Party, 1951-52?**

A. J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s. B. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. C. The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. D. Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade.

**Answer: A. Explanation: J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under KMPP into the Praja Socialist Party, 1951-52?**

A. In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. B. J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s. C. The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. D. Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade.

**Answer: B. Explanation: J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q15. Which option should a candidate retain when revising KMPP into the Praja Socialist Party, 1951-52?**

A. The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress. B. In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. C. J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s. D. The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description.

**Answer: C. Explanation: J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q16. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about KMPP into the Praja Socialist Party, 1951-52?**

A. Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951. B. The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress. C. In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. D. J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s.

**Answer: D. Explanation: J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q17. Which statement correctly identifies The Swatantra Party, 1959?**

A. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. B. In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. C. The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. D. Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under The Swatantra Party, 1959?**

A. The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. B. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. C. In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. D. The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Q19. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The Swatantra Party, 1959?

A. In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. B. Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951. C. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. D. The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Q20. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The Swatantra Party, 1959?

A. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election. B. Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951. C. The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress. D. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Q21. Which statement correctly identifies The 1964 split in the Communist Party of India?

A. Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade. B. The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. C. In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. D. The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under The 1964 split in the Communist Party of India?**

A. Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951. B. Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade. C. In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. D. The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q23. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The 1964 split in the Communist Party of India?**

A. The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress. B. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election. C. Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade. D. Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q24. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The 1964 split in the Communist Party of India?**

A. Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done. B. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election. C. Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951. D. Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Rajni Kothari's 'Congress system'?

A. The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. B. The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress. C. In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. D. Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Rajni Kothari's 'Congress system'?

A. The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress. B. The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. C. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election. D. Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Q27. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Rajni Kothari's 'Congress system'?

A. Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done. B. Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951. C. The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. D. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**



**Q28. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Rajni Kothari's 'Congress system'?**

A. The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. B. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election. C. Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done. D. The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Seat majorities on a minority vote share?**

A. In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. B. Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951. C. The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress. D. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election.

**Answer: A. Explanation: In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Seat majorities on a minority vote share?**

A. Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951. B. In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. C. Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done. D. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election.

**Answer: B. Explanation: In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**



**Q31. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Seat majorities on a minority vote share?**

A. The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. B. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election. C. In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. D. Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done.

**Answer: C. Explanation: In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q32. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Seat majorities on a minority vote share?**

A. By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority. B. The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. C. Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done. D. In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone.

**Answer: D. Explanation: In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q33. Which statement correctly identifies The Socialist Party, 1948, and its founders?**

A. The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress. B. Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951. C. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election. D. Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under The Socialist Party, 1948, and its founders?**

A. Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done. B. The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress. C. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election. D. The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q35. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The Socialist Party, 1948, and its founders?**

A. Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done. B. The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. C. The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress. D. By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q36. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The Socialist Party, 1948, and its founders?**

A. By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority. B. The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977. C. The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. D. The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q37. Which statement correctly identifies The CPI's 1948 Ranadive line and the Telangana uprising?**

A. Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951. B. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election. C. The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. D. Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under The CPI's 1948 Ranadive line and the Telangana uprising?**

A. The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. B. Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951. C. By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority. D. Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q39. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The CPI's 1948 Ranadive line and the Telangana uprising?**

A. The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. B. By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority. C. Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951. D. The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q40. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The CPI's 1948 Ranadive line and the Telangana uprising?**

A. The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977. B. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. C. By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority. D. Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q41. Which statement correctly identifies The DMK, founded 1949?**

A. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election. B. Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done. C. The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. D. By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under The DMK, founded 1949?**

A. By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority. B. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election. C. The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. D. The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

#### Q43. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The DMK, founded 1949?

A. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. B. The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977. C. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election. D. By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

#### Q44. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The DMK, founded 1949?

A. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. B. Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties. C. The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977. D. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

#### Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Congress's centralised ticket distribution?

A. Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done. B. By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority. C. The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977. D. The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**



#### Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Congress's centralised ticket distribution?

A. The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977. B. Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done. C. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. D. By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

#### Q47. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Congress's centralised ticket distribution?

A. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. B. The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977. C. Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done. D. Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

#### Q48. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Congress's centralised ticket distribution?

A. By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic. B. Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties. C. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. D. Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Multi-member and reserved constituencies, 1952 and 1957?**

A. The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. B. By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority. C. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. D. The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Multi-member and reserved constituencies, 1952 and 1957?**

A. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. B. The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. C. The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977. D. Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q51. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Multi-member and reserved constituencies, 1952 and 1957?**

A. Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties. B. By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic. C. The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. D. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC**

elimination.

**Q52. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Multi-member and reserved constituencies, 1952 and 1957?**

A. Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties. B. By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic. C. Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967. D. The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Right-of-Congress parliamentary growth by 1962?**

A. By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority. B. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. C. The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977. D. Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties.

**Answer: A. Explanation: By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Right-of-Congress parliamentary growth by 1962?**

A. By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic. B. By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority. C. Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties. D. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967.

**Answer: B. Explanation: By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q55. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Right-of-Congress parliamentary growth by 1962?**

A. Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967. B. Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties. C. By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority. D. By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic.

**Answer: C. Explanation: By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q56. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Right-of-Congress parliamentary growth by 1962?**

A. By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic. B. The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time. C. Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967. D. By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority.

**Answer: D. Explanation: By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Ram Manohar Lohia and 'non-Congressism'?**

A. The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977. B. Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties. C. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. D. By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Ram Manohar Lohia and 'non-Congressism'?**

A. Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties. B. The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977. C. By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic. D. Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q59. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Ram Manohar Lohia and 'non-Congressism'?**

A. The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time. B. By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic. C. The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977. D. Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q60. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Ram Manohar Lohia and 'non-Congressism'?**

A. The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time. B. Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. C. Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967. D. The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**



**Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Smaller Left formations: RSP and Forward Bloc?**

A. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. B. Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967. C. By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic. D. Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Smaller Left formations: RSP and Forward Bloc?**

A. Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967. B. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. C. The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time. D. By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q63. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Smaller Left formations: RSP and Forward Bloc?**

A. Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. B. The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time. C. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. D. Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q64. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Smaller Left formations: RSP and Forward Bloc?**

A. Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. B. Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. C. The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time. D. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and the Forward Bloc, strongest in Bengal and Kerala, added further plurality to a Left landscape that, alongside the CPI and CPI(M), was never a single unified bloc between 1947 and 1967. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Congress as an umbrella organisation?**

A. Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties. B. The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time. C. By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic. D. Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Congress as an umbrella organisation?**

A. Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. B. Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties. C. Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967. D. The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q67. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Congress as an umbrella organisation?**

A. Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. B. The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time. C. Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties. D. Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q68. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Congress as an umbrella organisation?**

A. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model. B. Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. C. Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. D. Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Congress functioned as a broad umbrella rather than an ideologically narrow party, holding Nehruvian planners, conservative traditionalists and regional bosses inside one organisation, so that much factional competition occurred inside Congress rather than between separate parties. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q69. Which statement correctly identifies The rise of state-level 'Syndicate' bosses?**

A. By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic. B. The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time. C. Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. D. Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967.

**Answer: A. Explanation: By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under The rise of state-level 'Syndicate' bosses?

A. Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. B. By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic. C. Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. D. The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time.

**Answer: B. Explanation: By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Q71. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The rise of state-level 'Syndicate' bosses?

A. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model. B. Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. C. By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic. D. Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed.

**Answer: C. Explanation: By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Q72. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The rise of state-level 'Syndicate' bosses?

A. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model. B. J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s. C. Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. D. By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic.

**Answer: D. Explanation: By the mid-1960s powerful state-level Congress leaders, later referred to as the 'Syndicate', had become organisationally decisive inside the party; this internal factional structure shapes the 1966 succession contest examined in the following topic. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Ideological range of the non-Congress opposition?

A. Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967. B. Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. C. Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. D. The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Ideological range of the non-Congress opposition?

A. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model. B. Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967. C. Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. D. Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Q75. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Ideological range of the non-Congress opposition?

A. Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. B. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model. C. Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967. D. J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC**



elimination.

**Q76. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Ideological range of the non-Congress opposition?**

A. J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s. B. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. C. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model. D. Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Between 1947 and 1967 the non-Congress opposition spanned the Hindu-nationalist Jana Sangh, the free-market Swatantra Party, several Socialist formations and a divided Communist movement, a genuine ideological range that could not translate into a single alternative to Congress before 1967. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q77. Which statement correctly identifies 1967: the watershed foreshadowed?**

A. The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time. B. Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. C. Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed. D. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

**Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under 1967: the watershed foreshadowed?**

A. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model. B. The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time. C. Purushottam Das Tandon defeated the Nehru-backed candidate for the Congress presidency in 1950; friction between Tandon's conservative leanings and Nehru's secular line led Tandon to resign in 1951, after which Nehru himself took over the party presidency. D. J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Q79. Which option should a candidate retain when revising 1967: the watershed foreshadowed?

A. J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s. B. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model. C. The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time. D. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Q80. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about 1967: the watershed foreshadowed?

A. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s. B. Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade. C. J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s. D. The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The steady decline in Congress's vote share through 1952, 1957 and 1962, together with two decades of splits, mergers and new party formations described in this topic, foreshadowed the 1967 general election, in which Congress lost power in eight states for the first time. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.**

### Semantic-completeness coverage drills - Modern Topic 33

| Control    | Required answer route                                  | Fatal trap                          |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Chronology | exact event sequence and bounded endpoint              | telescoping later events            |
| Ownership  | state what this topic owns and hands off               | duplicate cross-topic narrative     |
| Mechanism  | connect institution, resources, actors and consequence | list without causation              |
| Evidence   | named event/office/treaty/source plus qualification    | decorative evidence                 |
| PYQ        | preserve direct/adjacent status and key provenance     | invented direct PYQ or official key |
| Answer     | thesis -> evidence -> analysis -> limit -> verdict     | generic narrative                   |

**PYQ ownership control:** one direct 2024 Prelims party-leader route; the local Series-A key exists but no answer is inferred in this owner.

## PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

### Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

**Status:** 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: \_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

| Year | Paper        | Q  | PYQ demand (neutral rendering)                                                | Directive /&#8203;format                                                      | Source status                                                                       | Owner requirement                                                                |
|------|--------------|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024 | Prelims GS-I | 73 | Political party-leader matching (Jana Sangh, Socialist Party, CFD, Swatantra) | Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred | Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here | Cover the named fact/&#8203;concept and its likely statement-level distinctions. |

### What this owner must now support

- Political party-leader matching (Jana Sangh, Socialist Party, CFD, Swatantra)

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

**Question:** How did the 1948 ban on dual party membership shape the later development of India's opposition parties? Answer in about 150 words.

**Model thesis:** By forcing Socialists out of Congress, the 1948 ban started the non-Communist Left's independent, and recurrently fragmented, organisational history outside the ruling party.

### Evidence spine:

- Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed.
- J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s.
- The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress.
- Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951.

**Balance:** Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

**Conclusion:** By forcing Socialists out of Congress, the 1948 ban started the non-Communist Left's independent, and recurrently fragmented, organisational history outside the ruling party.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "How did the 1948 ban on dual party membership shape the later development of India's...", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model status:** The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise three named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

**How to improve this answer:** For “How did the 1948 ban on dual party membership shape the later development of India’s...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

**Question:** Distinguish the ideological platforms of the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party. Answer in about 150 words.

**Model thesis:** The Jana Sangh's Hindu-nationalist cultural politics and Swatantra's free-market economic conservatism opposed Congress from different directions and should never be treated as a single ideological bloc.

**Evidence spine:**

- The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model.
- The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s.

**Balance:** Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

**Conclusion:** The Jana Sangh's Hindu-nationalist cultural politics and Swatantra's free-market economic conservatism opposed Congress from different directions and should never be treated as a single ideological bloc.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Distinguish the ideological platforms of the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party. Answer in...”, coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model status:** The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise three named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Distinguish the ideological platforms of the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party. Answer in...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

**Question:** Rajni Kothari's 'Congress system' explains one-party dominance without denying genuine political competition. Examine. Answer in about 250 words.

**Model thesis:** Kothari's model shows factional competition occurring mainly inside Congress, with opposition parties acting as pressure groups rather than alternative governments, which is compatible with real, if bounded, competition.

**Evidence spine:**

- The political scientist Rajni Kothari coined the analytical term 'Congress system' to describe Congress as a 'party of consensus' that absorbed internal factions, casting opposition parties as parties of 'pressure' rather than credible alternative governments; this is an analytical label, not a Congress self-description.

- In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone.
- Through the 1950s and 1960s the Congress high command and its state units controlled nomination and ticket distribution centrally, a mechanism that let the party manage internal factional competition without it spilling into separate parties as often as it might otherwise have done.
- The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward.

**Balance:** Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

**Conclusion:** Kothari's model shows factional competition occurring mainly inside Congress, with opposition parties acting as pressure groups rather than alternative governments, which is compatible with real, if bounded, competition.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Rajni Kothari's 'Congress system' explains one-party dominance without denying genuine...", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model status:** The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise five named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Rajni Kothari's 'Congress system' explains one-party dominance without denying genuine...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

**Question:** Account for the instability of the non-Communist Left between 1948 and 1964. Answer in about 250 words.

**Model thesis:** Repeated splits and mergers, from the 1948 Socialist exit through the KMPP-PSP merger to continual PSP divisions, show an ideological family unable to settle its organisational form.

**Evidence spine:**

- Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed.
- J.B. Kripalani founded the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP) in 1951; in 1952 it merged with the Socialist Party to form the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), which itself split and re-formed repeatedly through the 1950s and 1960s.
- The independent Socialist Party formed after the 1948 Congress exit was led by figures including Jayaprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Deva, giving India's non-Communist Left its first organised party distinct from Congress.
- Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951.
- The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was founded in 1949 by C.N. Annadurai as a Dravidian, anti-Hindi regional opposition party in Madras state, and it went on to form the state's first non-Congress government after the 1967 general election.

**Balance:** Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.



**Conclusion:** Repeated splits and mergers, from the 1948 Socialist exit through the KMPP-PSP merger to continual PSP divisions, show an ideological family unable to settle its organisational form.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Account for the instability of the non-Communist Left between 1948 and 1964. Answer in...”, coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model status:** The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise five named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Account for the instability of the non-Communist Left between 1948 and 1964. Answer in...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

**Question:** 'Congress's parliamentary dominance between 1952 and 1967 rested on electoral arithmetic more than on political consensus.' Evaluate. Answer in about 300 words.

**Model thesis:** First-past-the-post seat majorities on a minority vote share, combined with a fragmented opposition, better explain Congress dominance than any claim of near-universal political consensus.

**Evidence spine:**

- In the 1952, 1957 and 1962 general elections Congress won comfortable parliamentary seat majorities while its national vote share stayed well under 50 per cent, a consequence of first-past-the-post arithmetic operating on a fragmented opposition rather than of majority consent alone.
- The 1952 and 1957 general elections used a mix of single-member and two-member constituencies, the latter reserved for Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes, a structural feature of the era's electoral system distinct from the uniform single-member constituencies used from 1962 onward.
- By the 1962 general election the Jana Sangh and the Swatantra Party had each secured a small but growing number of Lok Sabha seats, evidence that right-of-Congress opposition was gaining a parliamentary foothold even while Congress retained its overall majority.
- The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977.

**Balance:** Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

**Conclusion:** First-past-the-post seat majorities on a minority vote share, combined with a fragmented opposition, better explain Congress dominance than any claim of near-universal political consensus.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on “Congress's parliamentary dominance between 1952 and 1967 rested on electoral arithmetic...”, coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model status:** The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise six to eight named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Congress's parliamentary dominance between 1952 and 1967 rested on electoral arithmetic...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

**Question:** Trace the fragmentation of India's opposition political landscape from 1948 to 1967 and assess its consequences for the 1967 general election. Answer in about 300 words.

**Model thesis:** Two decades of bans, splits, mergers and new formations left a genuinely plural but disunited opposition whose slow consolidation, alongside Congress's declining vote share, produced the 1967 watershed.

### Evidence spine:

- Congress amended its own constitution in 1948 to bar dual membership, targeting Congress Socialist Party members who sat inside Congress while also belonging to a separate organisation; forced to choose, most Socialist leaders left Congress and an independent Socialist Party was formed.
- The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee, who had earlier resigned from Nehru's cabinet; the party had organisational links to the RSS network and stood for a Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line opposed to Congress's secular, planning-led model.
- The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by C. Rajagopalachari, Minoo Masani and N.G. Ranga on an economically conservative, free-market, anti-collectivisation platform directly opposed to Congress's 'socialistic pattern', and it became one of the larger non-Congress parliamentary parties by the 1960s.
- Ideological strain over the Sino-Soviet split and over differing responses to the 1962 border war split the Communist Party of India in 1964 into the CPI and the new CPI(M), leaving the organised Left divided rather than unified for the rest of the decade.
- Between 1948 and 1951 the Communist Party of India pursued an insurrectionary line associated with B.T. Ranadive and tied to the armed Telangana peasant uprising, before abandoning armed struggle for parliamentary participation by 1951.
- The Socialist leader Ram Manohar Lohia argued for 'non-Congressism', a strategy of opposition unity against Congress even across ideological differences; the doctrine had little practical electoral effect before 1967 but prefigured the logic later used to build the Janata coalition of 1977.

**Balance:** Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

**Conclusion:** Two decades of bans, splits, mergers and new formations left a genuinely plural but disunited opposition whose slow consolidation, alongside Congress's declining vote share, produced the 1967 watershed.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **trace** requires a direct position on “Trace the fragmentation of India's opposition political landscape from 1948 to 1967 and...”, coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model status:** The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise six to eight named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Trace the fragmentation of India's opposition political landscape from 1948 to 1967 and...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.